



## AFTER

Grant had wanted to avoid a protracted siege at Petersburg, but his failure to take the city when the chance arose would prolong the war into another year.

### NORTHERN DISILLUSION

Lee's war of attrition was wearing down the North's will to fight. **Copperheads, Peace Democrats, and other defeatist elements** were gaining support. If Lee could hold out long enough, the issue might be decided by the **presidential election** (see [Lincoln Prevails](#)) in November. Meanwhile, Grant kept **extending his Petersburg lines** (see [The Siege of Petersburg](#)) to the south and west, hoping to weaken Lee's own lines and capture his remaining railroads.

### SOUTHERN VICTORIES

On June 10, **Nathan Bedford Forrest** routed a force twice the size of his own at **Brice's Crossroads, Mississippi**, while on June 11–12, Wade Hampton stopped Sheridan's troopers at **Trevilian Station, Virginia**. On June 27, **Sherman was defeated** at **Kennesaw Mountain outside Atlanta**, while Jubal Early was preparing to **march on Washington** (see [The Valley Campaign](#)). All in all, it was a summer of doubt for the Union.